

Term Spring 2026	Course EAST 2520 01/GLBL 2309 01/PLSC 2466 01 - The Rise of China	Primary Dept PLSC	Primary Division Social Sciences	Enrolled: 262 Responded: 228
Instructors Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#1 What knowledge, skills, and insights did you develop by taking this course?

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 171

Respondent	Answer
1924521	modern chinese history in first part of class, and then shifted to current politics of china (poli sci, IR view). great overviews and also enabled you to fully understand all the incentives, drawbacks, loyalties, and other factors that are taken into account for major political decisions by both the chinese gov't and other nations in general.
1925054	h
1925189	I learned a lot about the various historical events that have shaped China into the country that it is today as well as the current events that are especially relevant to China's current economic, military and political position in the world today.
1925724	China's history and rise
1925766	Learned about China's history, governmental institutions, military, and contemporary politics.
1928913	Developed insights about Chinese history, political science, etc. Learned how China's importance in the world has changed across time and especially rose across the last 50 years.
1929419	I gained an understanding of Chinese history, domestic politics, and international politics. I also learned how to synthesize my knowledge and apply it to discuss Chinese politics and political issues with others.
1932565	Basic history about China from the Qing Dynasty to present-day, and a deeper understanding of the domestic and international relations China has.
1934649	I developed deep insights into the Chinese political structure and a broad understanding of their history.
1934683	I learned SO much about Chinese history and the background of the various issues concerning China. HIGHLY recommend to anyone trying to get more well-versed on this topic.
1936361	I learned a lot about China's history and the ins and outs of its current government. I hadn't taken a course before that was purely devoted to covering the topic of China, so it was pretty eye-opening for me.
1938168	history, politics, and international affairs in China
1939114	This course taught me about Chinese domestic politics and history. I believe the course's greatest lesson was how China's past has shaped its positions today.
1939315	I gained an understanding of China's history from the early ages to the present and how it has become a global superpower. The course is divided into two sections: Chinese history and politics (domestic/international). While Professor Mattingly covers a lot of material in one semester, he is able to teach the material at a surprisingly high level of depth.
1939870	I knew nothing about China before this course, so I learned a lot about the history, political structure, and current issues of China.
1940346	Chinese history and chinese politics.
1941777	I learned more about the history of China, its economy, and its contemporary politics.
1942416	I learned about the history of China and the institutions within the CCP.
1944860	I learned so much about the modern history of China, its inner political workings, and its foreign policy. I found the history section of the course much more interesting and insightful, but I also enjoyed the second half.
1944892	I learned so much foundational knowledge about China's history and politics. This class was incredibly relevant. I found myself applying concepts and historical events I learned from this class to other classes.
1947727	History and political systems of China.
1949337	I learned so much about Chinese history and the different leaders. I also learned about the current politics of China and how history impacts Chinese politics today.
1949787	I learned a lot about China.

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Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#1 What knowledge, skills, and insights did you develop by taking this course?

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 171

Respondent	Answer
1949788	Deep understanding of chinas history.
1949796	Foundations of Chinese history, modern politics, and policy. Great first political science class that helped me analyze China's rise from a critical and informed perspective.
1949800	Chinas history.
1949832	I learned a lot about Chinese history and how that has informed its present day policy.
1949848	I learned many insights into the inner workings of the Chinese government under all of its former leaders, as well as historical and contemporary informational surrounding its military, economic, and social strategy.
1949850	I gained so much knowledge on Chinese history, its present, and the views on current issues. This class was amazing.
1949898	This course introduced me to Chinas history and politics, and overall was super fun and insightful.
1949905	I learned a lot about chinas history and their political structure and the state of modern china. It's a great overview that leaves you wanting more.
1949952	Learned about Chinas rise. A bit about its history but mainly how it became a world power from Deng to Xi and now that effects today.
1949958	Great skills!
1950009	I learned both about China's history and political institutions, and about its current place in the world order, economically and militarily.
1950205	I learned how the history is relevant to understand the present.
1950436	History of the Chinese government, important players, current issues
1950462	The Rise of China offers an excellent introduction into the history, domestic politics, and foreign policy of Modern China. It gives a guide for understanding China's past and present, and, culminating in our crisis simulation at the end of the semester, clues at what the future might have in store.
1950765	Gained an overview of Chinese history as well as Chinas domestic politics and current international political conflicts.
1950908	Just like the scale of China, this class had to give an entire breadth of Chinas vast history, politics completely different from ours, and a good chunk of international relations. Through the course, I developed a much stronger understanding of the CCP, state-society relations, authoritarian governance, and the historical foundations behind modern U.S.-China tensions, all of which are crucial in gaining more knowledge in political science. I also learned how to critically analyze political systems outside of a Western framework and gained a deeper appreciation for how history, economics, and nationalism shape global politics today. The simulations, readings, and lectures especially helped me become more confident discussing current geopolitical issues in an informed and nuanced way.
1951016	I learned all about China's history as well as modern-day implications of the CCP system and ideology both on domestic and foreign politics. This course was extremely relevant and interesting!
1951164	Learned about the history and political system of China.
1951253	Learned all of Chinese history, relevant domestic politics and foreign politics
1951555	I learned more about the history, politics, and incentives of the Chinese state. I also gained knowledge in relevant political science literature, such as authoritarian politics, and helped me shed some stereotypes I had about Chinese politics and political economy.
1951626	I learned about the development of China over the last hundred years into the modern era.
1952999	I learned a lot about China and its history. It was interesting to know how China came about regarding their government, especially as one of the major powerhouses in the world. The way they handle their military and their people is so different from the U.S. and it was interesting to see a new perspective.

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Instructors				
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#1 What knowledge, skills, and insights did you develop by taking this course?

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 171

Respondent	Answer
1953226	I can contextualize the rise of China within a 2500 year context, including the century of humiliation, the rise of the CCP, Mao, Deng, and now Xi. I have a better understanding to critically engage with the relevant historical, economic, and geopolitical decision making that informs decision makers both within China, Southeast Asian countries, and the US
1953358	I learned more about the Chinese empires diplomatic and international spheres, particularly how China has evolved into a major global power.
1953390	I learned a lot about the history of China in the 19th to 21st centuries and the domestic/international politics of China and the CCP.
1953529	/
1953664	I learned a lot about the history and structure of China.
1960265	The history of China, as well as its approach to domestic and international politics.
1960888	Some political science theories like neo-realism, liberalism, and thucydides trap, Chinese history from the mid 1750s - present day, Chinese domestic politics, Chinese peoples relationship with their government and media, principles and foundations of modern China, Chinas relationship with its neighboring countries in terms of territorial disputes and trade, China-US relations.
1961700	I developed a lot of knowledge about the history and current politics of China that I had never learned about before. This course was my introduction to Chinese history, culture, and politics, and I now feel much better equipped to engage with news on China. An insight that I developed was that one's interpretation of another country's politics can be very influenced by one's surroundings, and getting to understand another country's politics while taking into account its cultural and historical context is vital to understand the country as a whole. One skill that I developed was having a foreign country's history and culture in the back of my mind while absorbing political news about that country.
1963129	I learned so much about China and its history in a way that felt more in-depth than any other course I've taken before. I never really got bored and felt completely engaged with the course's content.
1965183	The course showed me a lot of modern Chinese history, including the CCP leadership after Deng Xiaoping, which I had not come across at all in my time in high school. I also learned a lot about the various incentives that the CCP and its leaders face, giving me a great grasp of many political science concepts.
1965232	I learned the systems that drive China's actions from a political standpoint. I learned to examine the actions of China through historical, economic, geopolitical, and psychological lenses.
1966489	In depth insights into the political history of China that I was previously unaware of.

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Instructors
Mattingly, Daniel (P)

#2 Your level of engagement with the course was:
Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 72

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
3.9 ±0.9	3.9 ±1.0	3.9 ±1.0	3.9 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
very low	0
low	13
medium	30
high	75
very high	38

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Instructors Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#3 What are the strengths and weaknesses of this course and how could it be improved?

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 172

Respondent	Answer
1924521	strengths: class is well structured, assignments and expectations are clearly communicated, reasonable/lenient grading, fun final simulation. weaknesses: NA
1925054	j
1925189	The strengths are that the lectures were very engaging and had a lot of content each class.
1925724	I really liked the weekly quizzes because they required consistent studying and engagement with the material throughout the course. I also enjoyed the structure of the final simulation, which was a bit untraditional.
1925766	Strengths: Repeated low-stakes assessments give you many opportunities to succeed in the class. Class is well-organized, and the discussion sections don't feel like an afterthought like they sometimes do in other courses each one has a clear lesson plan. It really feels like Professor Mattingly and the TAs want to give you every opportunity to do well in the class. Weaknesses: Lecture slides don't have much text on them, so it is somewhat difficult to review for exams/catch up on any you might have missed. However, I thought the exams were very fair and didn't require memorizing exactly what had been said during the lectures anyway. This is a mostly perfect class.
1927444	Strength: Professor Mattingly is an amazing professor, course content is extremely relevant and necessary to understanding China's position as a growing power.
1928913	The strengths of the course are the very engaging lectures by Prof Mattingly and the interesting section content.
1929419	The strengths of the course are rooted in Professor Mattingly's lectures, such that he provides an incredible amount of valuable information on this topic. The sections are also very engaging, and the course prepares students well to not only think about the materials, but also discuss them meaningfully with others. There are no apparent weaknesses.
1929793	Strengths: I felt that the readings supplemented and built on the lecture content very well. Only weakness: I wish the slides had a bit more text, because it made it very hard to catch up if I had to miss lecture due to being sick. I often had to rely on the readings more if I missed a lecture and do my best to guess what may have been discussed beyond the slides (since the slide content is very minimal). Posting lecture recordings/making it easier to request recordings of them would be another solution
1932565	Section isn't necessary
1934649	Strengths is that the course is very engaging and is structured unlike many, accommodating the policy writers, historical thinkers, and Model UN.
1934683	Strengths: super interesting, the TFs are fantastic, no assessment was too taxing or infeasible, Professor Mattingly is very intelligent and approachable Weaknesses: none, honestly.
1936361	The lectures are super engaging and the perfect length, and the content is also very interesting. However, section didn't always feel the most efficient and I think the discussion leading element could be reworked so that instead of the TF presenting the questions, students could lead the discussion themselves instead.
1938168	This class is literally the platonic ideal of a large lecture. Mattingly is a fabulous lecturer, and the content was clearly organized and taught in an incredibly engaging way. Sections were good for clarifying understanding, and the final simulation was a ton of fun!
1939114	I really appreciated the readings included in the course. They felt very applicable to what we discussed in class, and it was great to hear the theory behind the topics we learned.
1939315	The strengths are definitely the lectures, they are very digestible and informative. The weekly quizzes are also not very stressful and a great way to check your understanding of lecture and readings. One weakness I would say is that discussion section is not always the most helpful and can be a little bland.

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#3 What are the strengths and weaknesses of this course and how could it be improved?

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 172

Respondent	Answer
1940346	Thought it was very solid.
1941777	The class was very engaging and informative. I think this class would benefit from smaller lectures.
1942416	Strengths: interesting and engaging lectures Weaknesses: none
1944860	Strengths: The entire class is a strength. The assignments were easy and fair, lectures were very engaging, and the lecture slides were posted for review. I thoroughly enjoyed the course. Weaknesses: Not necessarily a weakness, but this class is very surface level. You could just read like two books, and you would be just as intellectually stimulated as taking this class. I wish we got a bit deeper into Chinese politics and history, but that may be reserved for the seminar. Another weakness is honestly that everyone treats this class like a gut and puts in no effort, which makes activities like the final simulation kind of boring and unrealistic.
1944892	This course's structure, assignment pacing, and expectations were excellent. I appreciated having one discussion post per section, having two midterms, and a simulation. I feel like I was encouraged to learn, to be curious, and to think bigger, rather than just complete an assignment. I found the final simulation really fun.
1947727	Great lecturer. No weaknesses really. Really chill class. No stress, just needed to study up on all the study guide terms before the exam. Some discussion sections are better led than others.
1949337	The strenghts are the material and the way this course is set up. I think its fantastic how it goes from the history of China to the politics of china, both equally interesting. I genuinely learned so much, and Professor Mattingly and the TAs were fantastic. I felt the essay question on the second exam was very unclear, and it should've been explained better to us.
1949787	I liked the lectures a lot!
1949788	Strengths-good overview
1949795	Strengths: Professor Mattingly's lectures were amazing. The lectures were informative and easy to follow and understand. The readings were also interesting and provided differing perspectives on various geopolitical issues or other aspects of Chinese politics or U.S.-China relations. Not a weakness necessarily but the slides did not have many words on them so attending lecture is necessary to understanding them.
1949796	Can't really think of many faults, the lectures & readings were all very well thought-out and engaging.
1949800	.
1949832	I found the lectures to be very engaging, but the sections to be rather boring. I wonder if there would be a way to improve on the sections.
1949848	This course allows a great level of flexibility and immerses students through a variety of media. There were weekly quizzes, exams, and a final simulation that was really fun. I liked how the format was creative and engaging. That said, it felt at times that a full 50-minute discussion section seemed unnecessary, but that's a minor qualm.
1949898	I liked how each lecture had a different topic and kept the learning interesting.
1949905	It's a great overview of China. No weaknesses
1949958	I think the 2nd half was kind of repetitive
1949978	Great professor and lecturer; very well organized lectures each class that were engaging
1950009	I think this course is very well organized and structured, granting students multiple opportunities to demonstrate their knowledge. Lectures are very interesting, and students were also made aware from the start about how the course would progress, which is extremely helpful.
1950205	The class was well structured
1950436	Interesting overview of Chinese politics and international relations
1950462	Strengths: very important topic in the world; excellent structure, interesting reading materials, and insightful lectures; I liked the balance of written work and practical simulation work Weaknesses: better communication and could do with more academic rigour.

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#3 What are the strengths and weaknesses of this course and how could it be improved?

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 172

Respondent	Answer
1950765	Strengths: very approachable for people who have never studied Chinese history/politics, well-organized, great TFs and great professor, interesting readings and lectures, reasonable exams, final simulation was really cool! Weaknesses: Cant think of any!
1950908	Strengths: Dr. Mattingly was a GOAT, readings were engaging, the breakdown of the class makes everything relatively low stakes, and I looked forward to attending lectures because of how informative and engaging they are. Weaknesses: There are none! Maybe the content was a bit shallow, but this is a great introduction course that encourage me to take a lot more classes about China!
1951016	Strengths were Professor Mattingly's lectures (very interesting and well-done) as well as discussion section. No weaknesses!
1951164	I wish we talked about their economy like their real estate market for example. I loved it though; the content was super helpful in understanding China.
1951253	A perfect masterclass into anything China related
1951555	Strengths: lectures were really engaging and Professor Mattingly really contributes to this. Assignments are very straightforward and the lecture topics all tie together very well. Weaknesses: discussion sections felt repetitive but they were very helpful for checking my understanding of course material.
1951626	I thought this course was great with really solid lecture content and then good follow section discussions.
1952972	Strengths: super interesting lectures, content covers both history and poli sci, really relevant information that makes you more informed global citizen. Weaknesses: low engagement in section, readings not always the most interesting.
1952999	Sometimes it was hard to review based on the slides that were given but the study guide with the terms were so helpful.
1953358	I believe one of the courses greatest strengths was the professors teaching approach, as his lectures were highly engaging, accessible, and easy to follow.
1953390	The course was very interesting and very engaging, and the content we learned is very relevant to modern politics. The course presents an informational and accurate view of modern politics in China, I think the course could be improved by maybe incorporating the readings more in the course because it seemed like some of the readings were not tied into the material we learned in lecture.
1953529	/
1953664	I really liked this class as a background to China. However, I wish we spent less time on the government structure and more on Taiwan! We rushed at the end.
1960265	I see no ways in which this class can be improved.
1960888	Strengths: The class gives you a solid overview of Chinese history, domestic politics and international relations and also introduces some political science theories, which I think is great for general knowledge and for determining if political science is a path you want to pursue further. The readings and sections highlighted nuances to class content, so homework and section felt meaningful, deliberate, and purposeful. Someone in past reviews said this class would inform you to the point where you feel so much more knowledgeable about the world and are able to have more intellectual conversations, and though I tried, that was not my experience. Weaknesses: There was a general mismatch between what the syllabus said and what actually happened in the course in terms of midterms and finals and I think resolving this before the end of add/drop or at least the mid-term withdraw deadline could have been helpful to students who have many midterms and finals to manage. Firstly, the dates of the midterms and final were not determined until fairly late in the semester which made it a little hard to plan studying around other midterms and finals. Secondly, the syllabus said there would be an essay, but this component was replaced with a second midterm. Thirdly, the reading responses were supposed to count for 10% of the grade, but in the end they ended up having no weighting on the final grade and the weight of other section-related components increased. I dont know if the reading responses were evaluated within the other section-related components, but I thought it was strange/unfair to change grade distribution after the course finished without warning students in writing in advance. Also, I felt the exclusion of Hong Kong from the course content was pretty significant. Additionally, lectures closely followed the slides and even though Prof. Mattingly did share his insights occasionally, I would have appreciated more opportunities to hear his opinions on the topics he mentioned.

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Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#3 What are the strengths and weaknesses of this course and how could it be improved?

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 172

Respondent	Answer
1961700	Strengths - passionate and engaging professor, extremely informative and enlightening lectures, informative course readings, useful sections, good practice for learning how to engage with real-world foreign politics Weaknesses - N/A
1965183	The course shines when it focuses on leadership strategies of the CCP by really putting you in the mindset of a Chinese bureaucrat. The section discussions as well as the final simulation play to this strength really well. The lectures themselves can be hit or miss, but I thought Professor Mattingly did especially well in describing CCP history.
1966489	The format of the class was very helpful for comprehension. The workload was perfect---enough to comprehend in depth the material and not overwhelming.

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Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#4 What is your overall assessment of this course?

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 69

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.4 ±0.7	4.0 ±1.0	4.0 ±1.1	4.0 ±1.1

Choice Label	Counts
poor	0
fair	2
good	17
very good	54
excellent	86

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Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#5 The course was well organized to facilitate student learning.
 Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 71

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.5 ±0.6	4.1 ±1.0	4.1 ±1.0	4.1 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
strongly disagree	0
disagree	0
neutral	12
agree	60
strongly agree	85

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Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#6 I received clear feedback that improved my learning.

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 71

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.1 ±0.9	3.9 ±1.0	3.9 ±1.1	3.9 ±1.1

Choice Label	Counts
strongly disagree	1
disagree	4
neutral	36
agree	60
strongly agree	56

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Instructors				
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#7 Relative to other courses you have taken at Yale, the level of intellectual challenge of this course was:

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 70

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
2.7 ±0.7	3.2 ±0.9	3.3 ±0.9	3.3 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
much less	4
less	45
same	99
greater	7
much greater	3

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Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#8 Relative to other courses you have taken at Yale, the workload of this course was:
Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 70

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
2.5 ±0.8	3.0 ±0.9	3.0 ±0.9	3.1 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
much less	11
less	68
same	69
greater	8
much greater	2

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#9 Would you recommend this course to another student? Please explain.

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 158

Respondent	Answer
1924263	I would if you want to learn more about China overall, but this is a lecture that has to cover so much history, personalities, and current events, so it doesn't have the time to go very in-depth on any one period or event.
1924521	yes, great social science cred for stem majors! especially if you have a great TA
1925054	j
1925189	Yes I would recommend this course to another student because it addresses extremely relevant material in terms of global politics.
1925724	Absolutely. Professor Mattingly is an excellent lecturer, and this is a very current and relevant topic.
1925766	Yes I would recommend. Low workload and you learn a lot if you don't already know much about China.
1926137	Yes!
1927444	YES. This is one of my favorite classes I have taken at Yale. It is so so important to understand China's rise, no matter your major. Just so interesting. I highly recommend, especially if you have Professor Mattingly.
1928913	I would recommend because it's very interesting content, taught by a passionate professor.
1929419	I would recommend this course to other students, as it provides a great amount of information regarding Chinese history and politics that will make the student a more well-informed global citizen.
1929793	Yes! Every aspect of this course was very interesting, and it wasn't intimidating at all which makes it a great introduction to international relations/poli sci for both PLSC majors and non-PLSC majors alike. The lecture and readings were all fascinating, and the tests are very fair, so it's not hard to do well at all if you put in the work. If you take this course, you'll probably realize pretty early on that you don't have to do very much work to get by, but I would strongly encourage anyone taking this to be fully engaged in the lectures and section and do the readings, because you'll get so much more out of it.
1933112	100% take the course. It is not too difficult and you learn so much.
1933161	Yes. It's a great introduction to the history, modern politics, and contemporary issues surrounding China. Super important, especially in recent years.
1934112	Yes yes yes
1934649	YES. Awesome course.
1934683	YES! Please take this if you're even remotely interested in China and its impact on the global landscape.
1936361	Definitely - it's really interesting and covers a topic that everyone should at least have a surface understanding of in our current day and age. Professor Mattingly is a great lecturer and it's fun to take with friends, as well.
1938168	Yes! As someone who grew up in the U.S. public school system, this class taught me an unbelievable amount of information about international politics and the importance of China in the global order.
1939114	Yes, I would definitely recommend this course to another student. As China becomes an increasingly important player in the global stage, understanding its history and current affairs is very valuable, and this class does a great job in presenting that.
1939315	I would definitely recommend this course to another student if they do not already have a strong background in Chinese history or politics. If you do, the class is more of a review than anything and will be a very chill time. Regardless, the class is fun and informative about a nation more students should know about.
1939870	Yes! Please take it if you're interested in China at all. It's also very relevant today as China continues to rise as a global power.

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#9 Would you recommend this course to another student? Please explain.

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 158

Respondent	Answer
1940346	Yes it is good to learn about relevant topics.
1941777	Yes, this class is a great introductory class to China and its influence.
1942416	Yes, I thought this was a very fun class, especially with the engaging discussion sections.
1944860	Yes, if you are interested in gaining a basic understanding of Chinese history and politics. Do be warned that the information is incredibly surface-level, and won't really dig too deep.
1944892	I HIGHLY recommend other students take this course, regardless of what they study. I learned so much in such a short period of time, but the content all felt accessible. As a global citizen, it feels important to learn about other countries, and this was incredibly relevant to understanding the US-China relationship and understanding current events. Also, Professor Mattingly is a gem.
1947727	Yes! Learn about China in a low-stakes environment.
1949337	Yes, this has been my favorite class I've taken at Yale. You learn so much and the information is all so interesting and relevant.
1949787	Yes! Good background on China.
1949788	Yes, if you dont already know much about China!
1949790	Absolutely. One of the best intro classes I've taken at Yale.
1949791	Yes
1949795	Yes, the lectures were fun and the workload for the class is reasonable! The quizzes were based on the lectures and readings. The final simulation was also a fun way to synthesize everything we had learned.
1949796	Yes, great for those interested in political science or China, in general.
1949800	.
1949813	Yes, as an introduction to poli sci and the history/politics of China.
1949832	This class is both interesting, and very simple and straightforward. It requires very little work (you really do not even have to do the reading) and the grading on midterms is far too generous. If you want a challenge, stay away. If you want a good lecturer and interesting course that you can add on to a semester, take it.
1949839	Yes absolutely. Its a great course to take that wont overload you with assignments. I learned a lot without having to stress out and put a ton of hours into it, which i think proves the effectiveness of the course!
1949848	Yes, if you have any interest in history and government, this class is a must. It is not difficult, and the instructor is great. The lectures are logically structured, and the quizzes + exams are pretty straightfoward.
1949898	Yes!!
1949905	Absolutely I would recommend it. Prof. Mattingly is a great lecturer who is really interested in what he is teaching and the course material is very relevant.
1949952	Heck yeah very reasonable amount of work (I often found myself doing the readings for the love of the game) and I believe that I learned a lot (bc I did show up to lecture and pay attention.
1949958	Yes
1949980	Sure it wasnt terrible
1950009	Yes! This is a great opportunity to understand China's history and present, and it gives a great overview for those who haven't taken a class on the topic before.
1950017	Yes!!! This class is SUPER interesting with well-paced lectures and really interesting material! The teaching team is awesome, and the course is structured very well to facilitate student learning.

Term	Course	Primary Dept	Primary Division	Enrolled: 262
Spring 2026	EAST 2520 01/GLBL 2309 01/PLSC 2466 01 - The Rise of China	PLSC	Social Sciences	Responded: 228
Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#9 Would you recommend this course to another student? Please explain.

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 158

Respondent	Answer
1950205	I recommend this class to students who want to gain a better understanding of China's governmental structure, politics and history.
1950436	Yes! Professor Mattingly is a fantastic lecturer and the organization was strong
1950462	Certainly. As Professor Mattingly mentioned in our first lecture, every Yale student should take at least one course on China in their time here. Rise of China is one such course which offers an excellent grounding for understanding modern China.
1950765	Yes! This is a great course, especially for people who have no prior knowledge of Chinese history/politics and want exposure to the subject. The workload is very very manageable but always very interesting!
1950908	I never stop talking about this class, and how great it is! The lectures genuinely felt like watching a recreational YouTube video because of how engaging Dr. Mattingly is as a lecturer. He is such a talented, gifted professor and explains complex political and historical concepts in a way that is both accessible and intellectually stimulating, even for students without a background in political science. The course is extremely relevant to current events, the workload is manageable, and the final simulation was one of the most enjoyable assignments I have done at Yale. Best final ever!! I would recommend this class to almost anyone, especially students interested in politics, international relations, economics, or simply understanding one of the worlds most influential countries better.
1951253	Yes, one of the best taught classes at Yale
1951555	Yes; it is a good class even if you don't have a political science background. Much of the material is easy to understand and intuitive if you put in the time but the class also does not require a lot of extensive studying; much of it is memorizable.
1951626	Yes, its super interesting and I think becoming increasingly relevant.
1951894	It's a solid course on China if you haven't taken one before graduating. You could probably get lots of the same content from a podcast or wikipedia
1952972	Yes, absolutely! Fantastic lectures that were well paced and full of so much interesting information. Not too heavy of a workload and a class I looked forward to each week.
1952999	Yes. It was interesting to learn about China, especially with their involvement in media and the world. I loved how the final assessment made us put ourselves into the shoes of a specific officer within China and try to emulate their decisions. It was so fun and I would totally recommend it to a friend based on how interactive it was.
1953026	100%. Not a crazy workload but learned genuinely so much. Daniel Mattingly is an engaging lecturer and my TF Mel was amazing.
1953174	Absolutely. Incredibly interesting course that summarizes the history and political nuances of a China that has risen to meet the West. Professor Mattingly is an excellent lecturer and I cannot recommend his open lunches enough as an opportunity to get even further depth into course material.
1953226	I would! This is a low stress way to learn of the history, successes, and failures of a nation poised to play a critical role in shaping the 21st century.
1953358	Yes, I would highly recommend this course because it examines the material historically at the beginning of the semester before transitioning into Chinas domestic and international politics, military development, and economic influence. It offered a compelling and insightful overview of the political evolution of China.
1953390	Yes, I would totally recommend this course. Professor Mattingly is a very engaging lecturer and the course content is not only very interesting but also very relevant. The course is also not very high workload or stressful, it has very reasonable assignments.
1953529	/
1953664	Yes, it is really interesting and not that hard.
1960265	Teaches you about one of the most important civilizations in the world that many in the West have at best elementary knowledge about.

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Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#9 Would you recommend this course to another student? Please explain.

Instructor(s): Mattingly, Daniel (P)

Declined to Answer Question: 158

Respondent	Answer
1960888	Yes - it's a great 5th or 6th class and a pretty decent social science credit, if you need it. The readings and sections highlighted nuances to class content, so homework and section felt meaningful, deliberate, and purposeful. Fairly gutty (probably spent ~2hrs/week outside of class on the weeks with no midterm or final). A lot of people suggest taking this course with friends, which I didn't do but agree with.
1961700	Yes! This is a very fun, enlightening course that exposed me to content I had never learned before.
1963129	Certainly! Such an interesting course with great TA's and an amazing professor.
1965183	Yes, I would recommend the course. It provides a lot of easily digestible information on China and its politics, which is of interest to many people, and serves as a way for that information to be accessed by students regardless of their experience in political science. The workload is also not that intense, making this course an easy shoe-in at any point in one's college career.
1965232	Very interesting class, would certainly recommend even for laypeople such as myself. I think this course will help me understand the geopolitical shifts of our generation and beyond with more complexity.

Term Spring 2026 Course EAST 2520 01/GLBL 2309 01/PLSC 2466 01 PLSC Primary Dept Primary Division Social Sciences Enrolled: 262 Responded: 228
- The Rise of China

Instructors
Mattingly, Daniel (P)

#10 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?

Instructor(s): Pavlik, Melissa

Responses for Instructor: 20
Declined to Answer Question: 12

Respondent	Answer
1925054	h
1925766	Mel is probably the best TA I have had during my time at Yale. She brought such a positive attitude to the classroom, and she seemed genuinely interested in engaging with the ideas her students shared. She was also very responsive via email and clear about expectations for grading etc.
1929419	Melissa encouraged students to participate in discussions and created a collaborative and fruitful section environment.
1929793	Mel was wonderful! I really appreciated how she encouraged us and made us feel comfortable with participating in section, which I was a bit intimidated to do at first as one of the only freshmen in the section. The questions she asked to prompt our thinking were always intriguing and helpful to our understanding of the material. I could tell she was very invested in our success, which made section fun to go to every week!
1933161	Mel was an amazing TF. The section environment was always fun, yet focused. I feel like she did a good job of steering discussion, helping generate good insight throughout the course. She also did a great job making sure we were prepared for the exams.
1934683	Melissa was so lovely, kind, thoughtful, and accessible. She is amazing!
1939870	Amazing TF! Super kind, receptive, and supportive of student learning. She led sections very well and encouraged interesting discussion.
1942416	Strengths: very nice and helpful Weaknesses: none
1944892	Mel is a wonderful teaching fellow. Our discussion section was always engaging because she is a strong facilitator. Mel was consistently responsive and always made herself available to students.
1949787	She is great! Facilitates discussion well and makes sure everyone is included while keeping it interesting.
1949796	Honestly, one of the best TFs I've ever had. She was extremely understanding and communicative at all times. Always went out of her way to make sure we understood the material and engaged with it beyond the surface level.
1949862	Shes amazing
1949952	She was well prepared but lead the class discussion a little too aggressively (also bc she was so nice and made it clear there were no consequences to not doing work). Id recommend her being harsher but she was also really nice and really well prepared and did lead a good discussion despite the students not having done most of their work.
1950765	She was wonderful! One of the best TFs Ive had. Facilitated discussion extremely well, very approachable, and great at answering questions. Made section fun!
1951016	Mel was an awesome TF! She was super kind and great at looping everyone into weekly discussions while also adding relevant insights of her own. I was super lucky to have her as my TF!
1951253	Best TA I have ever had. Led engaging discussions and was incredibly supportive.
1953026	Mel was such an incredible TF. I think in a class like Rise of China that spans so much content, having a TF that could run through concepts in a clear but engaging way was super essential. She was also great at making everyone in section feel comfortable participating from pretty early on, which made discussions really fun and interesting from the beginning.
1953174	Incredibly dedicated and high-energy. Made section very interesting and did an excellent job facilitating discussion with alternate perspectives and questions.

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Instructors				
Mattingly, Daniel (P)				

#10 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?
Instructor(s): Pavlik, Melissa

Responses for Instructor: 20
Declined to Answer Question: 12

Respondent	Answer
1960284	I loved Mel! She was so kind and understanding. She truly understood how to lead section.
1961700	Strengths - made all content very engaging, reinforced learning during section, provided great feedback Weaknesses - N/A

Term	Course	Primary Dept	Primary Division	Enrolled: 262
Spring 2026	EAST 2520 01/GLBL 2309 01/PLSC 2466 01 - The Rise of China	PLSC	Social Sciences	Responded: 228

Instructors
Mattingly, Daniel (P)

#11 What is your overall assessment of the Teaching Fellow?

Instructor(s): Pavlik, Melissa

Responses for Instructor: 29
Declined to Answer Question: 3

Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.9 ±0.4	4.3 ±1.0	4.3 ±1.0	4.3 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
poor	0
fair	0
good	0
very good	4
excellent	25

